

PRACTICAL TEST AUTOMATION WITH PLAYWRIGHT

Playwright Command Cheat Sheet

The CLI commands you will use every day, in one place.

Introduction

Keep this beside you while you work. It collects the Playwright CLI commands you will reach for most often, from running tests to debugging and reporting.

Running Tests

Command	Does
<code>npx playwright test</code>	Run all tests
<code>npx playwright test file.spec.ts</code>	Run one file
<code>npx playwright test -g "name"</code>	Run tests matching a title
<code>npx playwright test --project=firefox</code>	Run one project/browser
<code>npx playwright test --headed</code>	Run with a visible browser
<code>npx playwright test --repeat-each=10</code>	Stress-test for flakiness

Debugging

Command	Does
<code>npx playwright test --ui</code>	Open UI mode (watch/step/time-travel)
<code>npx playwright test --debug</code>	Step through with the Inspector
<code>npx playwright show-trace trace.zip</code>	Open a trace
<code>npx playwright codegen <url></code>	Record actions and get locators

Reports & Setup

Command	Does
<code>npx playwright show-report</code>	Open the HTML report
<code>npx playwright install</code>	Install browsers
<code>npx playwright install --with-deps</code>	Install browsers + OS deps (CI)
<code>npm init playwright@latest</code>	Scaffold a new project

Updating Snapshots

- `npx playwright test --update-snapshots` — refresh visual baselines (review the diff first)

Practical Exercise

Run a single test by title with `-g`, then open it in UI mode, then view the HTML report. Get comfortable switching between them.

Common Mistakes

- Always running the full suite when `-g` would be faster.
- Forgetting `--with-deps` in CI.
- Updating snapshots without reviewing the diff.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

Master `--ui` mode and `-g` early. Being able to run and inspect exactly the test you care about — instantly — makes you dramatically faster at writing and fixing automation.